

Launch + ICN — Formation-to-Governance Discovery

THURSDAY 2026-05-21 · 10:30–11:30 AM ET · 60 MINUTES

Visual notes page. Use to keep the conversation on the seam: formation workflow → durable institutional memory.

POSTURE

GOAL	Find whether the formation workflow has a clean seam with ICN's durable governance / memory layer.	NOT	A launch. A pitch. A pilot. A product demo. A replacement for Launch.
TALK	1–2 min per beat, then listen 5+ min.	WIN	One smallest sanitized rehearsal target — or a clear "not useful yet."

WHAT LAUNCH APPEARS TO FOCUS ON

LAUNCH CONTEXT — from public material

- Guided onboarding / decision-tree framing for co-op formation
- Teams, co-founders, task assignment, comments on steps
- Documents, change history, secure document portal
- Advisors / TA providers / lawyers / CPAs / co-op networks
- Mobile, print, multilingual access (English + Spanish, expandable)
- Reducing TA bottlenecks *without* replacing TA providers
- Framing: "*make the ask feel doable.*"

THE INSTITUTIONAL SPINE

Standing → Authority → Decision → Obligation → Effect → Receipt → Evidence → Review

Eight words. Introduce in one breath. Ask whether the order matches how formation work actually moves into ongoing governance.

LAUNCH TRANSLATION OF THE SPINE

LAUNCH SURFACE	ICN SUBSTRATE QUESTION
Founding team / co-founders	Who has standing?
Roles / advisor relationship	Who can act, review, guide, or certify?
Formation path selected	What process is this group actually in?
Governance doc drafted	Under whose authority?
Task assigned	Who owes what by when?
Service provider engaged	What obligation crosses the boundary?
Milestone completed	What effect happened?
Approval / confirmation	What receipt exists?
Document / change history	What evidence survives?
Launch → operating co-op handoff	What carries forward?
Patronage / internal capital records	Governance evidence vs. accounting record?

60-SECOND OPENER

From what I understand, Launch is trying to make co-op formation less like wandering through a legal, financial, and governance junk drawer with a flashlight dying in your mouth.

You are breaking the process into steps people can actually move through: teams, documents, tasks, advisors, service providers, and milestones.

ICN is coming at the next layer: once those steps become real institutional facts, how does the co-op remember them? Who has standing? Who was authorized? What decision happened? What obligation followed? What evidence survives when the advisor, organizer, or founding team rotates out?

I am not here to pitch ICN as a replacement for Launch. I want to understand whether there is a clean seam between Launch's formation workflow and ICN's durable governance / memory layer — or whether that seam does not exist yet.

PRIMARY WALKTHROUGH — FORMATION → DURABLE GOVERNANCE HANDOFF

Walk one beat at a time. After each beat ask: *How does this happen today? What state needs to persist? Who needs to trust it later? Where would a receipt help, and where would it become bureaucracy?*

1

Group enters Launch onboarding

TODAY Decision-tree intake / wizard.

ICN First institutional record that this group exists and is forming?

2

Founding team / co-founders identified

TODAY Roster inside Launch.

ICN When do these people gain standing — and what kind?

3

Roles & advisor / TA / provider relationships established

TODAY Relationship records in Launch.

ICN Who can act with what authority, on whose behalf, with what professional scope?

4

Formation path selected

TODAY Co-op model / legal entity track chosen.

ICN What process is this group in, and what authority does that selection carry?

5

Governance documents drafted

TODAY Drafts in document portal.

ICN Under whose authority, and what receipt when adopted?

6

Tasks assigned to co-founders / advisors / providers

TODAY Task surface in Launch.

ICN Each task is an obligation — by whom, to whom, owed by when, completed by what evidence?

PRIMARY WALKTHROUGH (continued)

7

Legal / accounting / co-op-developer service provider loop triggered

TODAY Vendor / advisor engagement, often outside Launch.

ICN What crosses the boundary, what comes back, what record proves both?

8

Decision or milestone completed

TODAY Checked box / signed doc / meeting minute.

ICN What effect did it have, against what authority, with what receipt?

9

Member standing / board authority / operating roles established

TODAY The moment Launch hands off to "the co-op exists now."

ICN What carries forward — and what is silently dropped?

10

Economic participation / patronage / allocation records become relevant

TODAY Usually CPA / bookkeeper territory.

ICN Where does governance evidence meet accounting record? See economic branch below.

11

Handoff into durable institutional memory / ongoing governance

TODAY Fuzzy moment where Launch's role recedes.

ICN What record survives that next year's board, a funder, a regulator, or a future member can verify?

BRANCHES — OPEN ONLY IF ASKED

ECONOMIC / PATRONAGE / INTERNAL CAPITAL	ADVISOR / SERVICE PROVIDER	NYCN / SUMMIT (BACKUP EXAMPLE)
• Internal capital account records as institutional memory • Patronage / allocation records as provenance • Settlement intent / position views • Boundary: governance evidence vs. accounting record <i>Inquiry only. Not an accounting system, bank, payment app, wallet, or money transmitter.</i>	• What lawyers / CPAs / bookkeepers / TA providers need to see • What they can attest to • What stays under their professional authority • Cross-boundary obligation records	• Session → public program • Feedback → next-year obligation • Accessibility accommodation • Sponsor commitment <i>Use only if the formation seam feels too abstract.</i>

QUESTIONS TO ASK

ON LAUNCH'S WORKFLOW

Q *Where does a formation workflow lose institutional memory?*

Q *What records matter after the co-op is formed?*

Q *Where do teams / tasks / docs / advisor notes need continuity?*

Q *What milestones are legally / accounting / governance-meaningful?*

ON STANDING / AUTHORITY

Q *When does someone become a member / founder / board actor / officer / advisor?*

Q *Who can authorize a document, filing, provider engagement, or milestone?*

ON ADVISORS / SERVICE PROVIDERS

Q *What do lawyers, CPAs, bookkeepers, TA providers, or co-op developers need to see and attest to?*

Q *What must remain under professional authority, not ICN's?*

ON PATRONAGE / INTERNAL CAPITAL (only if opened)

Q *Where do internal capital account / patronage / allocation records first enter the workflow?*

Q *What is governance evidence vs. accounting record vs. professional execution? What should ICN never touch?*

ON ANTI-SOFTWARE BOUNDARIES & NEXT STEP

Q *What must stay human / process-first? What should expire? Never be public? Need explicit consent?*

Q *Smallest fictional / sanitized formation-to-governance rehearsal worth doing? Who else should be in that room?*

When critique lands, do not defend. Capture the objection. Translate it into a design question. Ask what would make the thing safer or more useful. The meeting's value is calibration, not persuasion.

CLAIMS NOT TO MAKE

- Not replacing Launch.
- Not replacing TA providers, lawyers, CPAs, bookkeepers, or co-op developers.
- Not production-ready. Not externally audited. Not legally / regulatorily certified.
- Not a live federation. Not an end-to-end federation lifecycle.
- Not a formally committed cooperative pilot. NYCN is an active partnership track. Launch is a discovery conversation, not a pilot.
- Not a live member app. Not a live steward cockpit dashboard. Not a signed production appliance.
- Not accounting software. Not payment / banking / wallet software.
- Receipts alone do not prove legitimacy. Authority shortcuts must label themselves.
- Vocabulary: **settlement, obligation, allocation, unit, position, receipt, provenance, evidence.** Avoid the forbidden financial / crypto vocabulary listed in the Thursday brief.
- Community-infra (Matrix / n8n / bridge / etc.) is a separate workstream — do not mention unless asked.
- No real Launch, NYCN, or private partner data has been or will be put in git.

AFTER THE MEETING — CAPTURE

Real / useful	Wrong / overbuilt / unclear
Clean seam identified (formation → governance)	Seam rejected / not ready
Smallest rehearsal candidate	Economic / patronage / accounting questions
Who else should join	Follow-up action / cadence